

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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I NEED GOD'S PRESENCE MORE THAN UNDERSTANDING MORE THAN I NEED TO UNDERSTAND

In my journey of walking with Jesus my recent thoughts have been focused on the following statement –

**“I need God's presence more than understanding –
more than to understand”**

Man's disposition

We as people generally want to understand the reason for those things taking place around us.

Questions like:

- Why do people behave that way?
- Why is there so much anger and cruelty in our world?
- Why doesn't God do something about the injustice in the world?
- Why certain things are happening to us?
- Why did I have to go through this experience and not others? Why me?
- Why can't I be normal like other people who do not seem to be struggling with their own image and always expressing confidence?
- Why are some of my prayers delayed or not answered?

In our walk with Jesus, there are many things that happen to us in life that we do not understand the reasons behind them and this can trouble us.

We ask ourselves **“if I only knew why, then I could possibly find some relief or satisfaction”?**

According to the scriptures God is always present with us as followers of Christ. He has promised never to leave or forsake us.

Positionally this is our legal status with God.

However, it is possible that though we truly believe (objectively) that to be true it may not be a living reality to us in such a way that it affects our whole disposition and how we live our lives daily.

There are times when our belief in the truth of his presence being with us seems to have little effect on the reality side of our lives, and so we become more aware of our need **for his presence** to effectively settle and quieten our hearts and minds and give us an inner awareness of his abiding peace that 'all is well', irrespective of those unanswered questions we may have about life's circumstances.

People's well-meaning suggestions

I have noticed that when any of us are going through some event or circumstance in our lives, there are people who will kindly offer their suggestions of the reasons for what is happening to us but mostly those suggestions don't seem to have lasting power to inwardly satisfy. We are still empty of the answers as to 'why' those events.

Our suggestions

Then we have our own thoughts and plausible suggestions as to why such events are happening or have happened, but they too fail to give lasting inner satisfaction.

Knowledge is important but in understanding what God might be doing in our lives and knowledge alone does not always satisfy and settle our hearts and minds.

So, I have come to realise that it is his presence that I need more than understanding – more than trying to understand reason why certain things are happening in my life and the complexities of God's working in my life.

This is also true for all of us

Therefore, in those times when I do not know why some things are happening in life, I then seek to experience the tangible presence of God, for I have found that his presence settles the many issues that constantly arise in my thoughts and feelings and also empowers me with a new sense of strength and positions me to continue on to do what I have been called to do.

Can you identify with him also?

His presence

- But his presence does empower me to continue serving and fulfilling those things that have been entrusted to me to do.
- His presence comforts, consoles and causes a person to rise above that prevailing pressure for us to know.
- His presence satisfies in such a way that we are lifted up, distanced and out of reach from that constant mind set of questioning and wanting to know why.
- I have found that there is peace and tranquillity in sensing and hearing his voice say "I am here with you".
- The reality of sensing his all sufficiency keeps me from worrying and trying to find a cause for those events of life.
- His presence is like a cloud that envelopes us and produces a world that gives assurance and confidence that he is in control.
- **SO, THIS IS WHY I NEED HIS PRESENCE MORE THAN UNDERSTANDING.**
- **MORE THAN KNOWLEDGE (THAN KNOWING).**
- The questions of life and its 'whys' are no longer an issue because his presence satisfies sufficiently that the answers are not a worrying matter.
- **Truly we DO need his presence more than we understanding things.**

Trying to understand all the events and happenings of our lives can cause us to stop, hesitate or fail to move on in God's work, **BUT his presence empowers us** to keep on moving forward.

In following Jesus there is always the danger of depending on **our knowledge** instead of dependence on God which causes us to regulate **our daily walk** by what **we know** rather than listening to what God is saying to us through his Word or Spirit.

God made the hearing ear.

Proverbs 20:12 The hearing ear, and the seeing eye, the Lord hath made even both of them. KJV

Proverbs 20:12 The Lord has made both these things: ears to hear and eyes to see. NCV

Jesus' spoke of having an 'ear that hears'.

Mark 4:23 If anyone has ears to hear, let him hear." ESV

Developing this skill.

This is why we need to develop our 'hearing' ability (having an 'hearing ear') by asking the Lord to help us develop this skill.

God opens our ears – every day.

Isaiah 50:4-5. "... Morning by morning he awakens; he awakens my ear to hear as those who are taught. - 5 The Lord God has opened my ear, and I was not rebellious; I turned not backward. ESV

Prayer

"Lord let us focus more on your presence than on our understanding"

